

SECTION 1 — IMPORT-READY SOURCE FILE

AP U.S. History Free-Response Practice Exam 7

APUSH-SAQ7-001

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 2 — Period 2: 1607–1754

Period: Period 2: 1607–1754

Theme: WOR — America in the World

Historical Reasoning: Comparison

Source Type: Secondary text source

Prompt:

Source A: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation. A historian of Spanish North America argues that Spanish colonization in the borderlands relied heavily on missions, presidios, and efforts to convert Native peoples to Christianity. According to this interpretation, Spanish imperial control often depended on religious institutions, military outposts, and negotiated or coerced labor systems.

Source B: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation. A historian of French North America argues that French colonization often depended on trade alliances, diplomacy, and cooperation with Native communities. According to this interpretation, the fur trade encouraged a smaller settler presence and made French influence dependent on Native knowledge, mobility, and political relationships.

- (a) Describe one major difference between Spanish and French approaches to colonization reflected in the two interpretations.
- (b) Explain one piece of historical evidence that supports the argument in Source A.
- (c) Explain one piece of historical evidence that supports the argument in Source B.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Describes a valid difference, such as Spanish reliance on missions, presidios, conversion, and settlement in the borderlands compared with French reliance on fur trade alliances, diplomacy, and smaller settler populations.
- (b) 1 point: Explains relevant evidence supporting Source A, such as Spanish missions in California, New Mexico, Texas, or Florida; presidios; missionary conversion efforts; Pueblo labor demands; or conflicts such as the Pueblo Revolt.
- (c) 1 point: Explains relevant evidence supporting Source B, such as French fur trade networks, alliances with Native nations, coureurs de bois, Jesuit missions connected to diplomacy, French activity along the St. Lawrence and Great Lakes, or Native-French military cooperation.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should compare imperial strategies without assuming all European colonizers acted in the same way. It should explain how religion, trade, military power, and Native diplomacy shaped different colonial systems.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ7-002

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 9 — Period 9: 1980–Present

Period: Period 9: 1980–Present

Theme: GEO — Geography and the Environment

Historical Reasoning: Sourcing / POV / Purpose / Audience

Source Type: Primary text source

Prompt:

Source: Original simulated source based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

A community organizer speaking at a county meeting after protests against a hazardous-waste landfill, North Carolina, 1982.

“We are told the site was chosen by science, but the trucks arrive in a poor Black county where officials assume people have little power to object. Clean land and safe water should not depend on income, race, or political connections. If environmental protection means anything, it must protect the communities asked to carry the risks.”

(a) Identify one historical development that shaped the situation described in the source.

(b) Explain how the author’s point of view likely influenced the argument made in the source.

(c) Explain one way the source reflects broader changes in environmental or civil rights activism in the late twentieth century.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

(a) 1 point: Identifies a relevant development, such as the rise of environmental justice activism, protests over hazardous-waste siting, concerns about toxic pollution, civil rights activism after the 1960s, or community resistance to unequal environmental burdens.

(b) 1 point: Explains that the author’s perspective as a local community organizer shaped the argument by emphasizing racial inequality, poverty, political power, clean water, local risk, and unequal treatment by government or industry.

(c) 1 point: Explains a broader change, such as the connection between civil rights and environmental activism, grassroots community organizing, challenges to technocratic decision-making, increased attention to pollution in poor communities, or demands for federal and state accountability.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should connect the source to environmental justice, not just environmentalism in general. It should explain how race, class, local power, and public health became central to late twentieth-century environmental activism.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ7-003

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 4 — Period 4: 1800–1848

Period: Period 4: 1800–1848

Theme: ARC — American and Regional Culture

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Non-text source

Prompt:

Source: Described material-culture source created for this practice exam.

The object is a common school primer used in a northern classroom, circa 1840. Its cover shows a teacher standing beside a blackboard while boys and girls sit on benches holding small books. The inside pages include alphabet exercises, short moral lessons about punctuality and honesty, basic arithmetic, and a reading passage about the duties of citizens in a republic. A handwritten note in the margin says, “Good order makes good scholars.”

- (a) Describe one educational or cultural goal reflected in the source.
- (b) Explain one historical factor that contributed to the growth of common schools in the early nineteenth century.
- (c) Explain one way common schools affected American society during this period.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Describes a valid goal, such as promoting literacy, moral discipline, republican citizenship, social order, basic numeracy, Protestant-influenced values, or shared cultural habits among children.
- (b) 1 point: Explains a relevant factor, such as the rise of public school reform, concerns about republican citizenship, urbanization, immigration, market changes requiring literacy, state-level reform efforts, or the work of reformers such as Horace Mann.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a relevant effect, such as expanded literacy, greater state involvement in education, promotion of civic values, social discipline, cultural assimilation, gendered teaching roles, or unequal access to education by race, region, class, or gender.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should interpret the primer as evidence of broader educational reform and cultural goals. It should connect schooling to citizenship, moral order, literacy, and social change rather than treating it only as a classroom object.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-DBQ7-001

Section: DBQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 7 — Period 7: 1890–1945

Period: Period 7: 1890–1945

Theme: MIG — Migration and Settlement

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Seven-document set

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which the Great Migration transformed African American life and northern urban society from 1910 to 1940.

Document 1

Author/Origin: Described migration map created for this practice exam, United States, 1910–1940.

Source Type: Described map.

The map shows arrows moving from Mississippi, Alabama, Georgia, Louisiana, South Carolina,

and Texas toward Chicago, Detroit, Cleveland, New York, Philadelphia, Pittsburgh, and St. Louis. The largest arrows lead from the rural South to Chicago and Detroit. A note explains that migration increased during World War I, continued through the 1920s, and slowed during the Great Depression but did not stop.

Sourcing Cues: The map emphasizes internal migration from the South to industrial and urban centers in the North and Midwest.

Document 2

Author/Origin: Original simulated letter from a Black migrant to relatives in Mississippi, Chicago, 1917; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Primary text source.

“The packinghouse work is cold and hard, but the pay is more than I ever saw for a week’s labor in the Delta. I do not say Chicago is free of insult or danger. Landlords crowd us into certain blocks, and some white workers resent our arrival. Still, a man may vote here, read the paper without fear, and hope his children will see a different road.”

Sourcing Cues: The letter reflects the perspective of a Black southern migrant weighing economic opportunity, racial discrimination, political rights, and urban challenges.

Document 3

Author/Origin: Original simulated editorial from a southern county newspaper, Georgia, 1918; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Newspaper-style excerpt.

“Labor agents have filled the countryside with promises of northern wages. Farms now struggle to find hands at planting time, and families who once knew their place are being encouraged to abandon the communities that fed them. Local leaders must act before outside agitators empty the fields.”

Sourcing Cues: The editorial reflects the viewpoint of white southern elites concerned about labor control, racial hierarchy, and the loss of Black agricultural workers.

Document 4

Author/Origin: Industrial labor table created for this practice exam, selected northern cities, 1910–1930.

Source Type: Data table.

The table is titled “Selected Changes in Black Urban Employment.”

City | Common job growth for Black workers, 1910–1930 | Common limits

Chicago | meatpacking, steel, railroads, domestic service | segregated neighborhoods, job discrimination

Detroit | automobile factories, foundries, service work | racial tension, unequal promotion

Pittsburgh | steel, railroads, hotels, domestic service | dangerous work, exclusion from many skilled jobs

New York | service work, garment-related labor, port work | high rents, housing discrimination

A note beneath the table states: “Industrial labor demand expanded opportunities but did not eliminate discrimination in hiring, housing, or unions.”

Sourcing Cues: The table highlights both economic opportunity and continuing racial barriers.

Document 5

Author/Origin: Original simulated report from a northern urban reform organization, Detroit, 1925; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Reform report excerpt.

“New arrivals require housing assistance, employment information, legal advice, and protection from fraudulent landlords. Churches, mutual-aid groups, women’s clubs, and neighborhood associations have become essential institutions. The city cannot pretend that migration is temporary; it must plan for schools, health services, and fair housing.”

Sourcing Cues: The report reflects urban reformers’ and community organizations’ concern with settlement, housing, and institution-building among migrants.

Document 6

Author/Origin: Described photograph from a Black neighborhood business district, Chicago, circa 1928.

Source Type: Described photograph.

The photograph shows a busy street with a newspaper office, a beauty salon, a church entrance, a small grocery, and a political club office. Men and women in coats stand near storefront windows advertising concerts, lectures, and fraternal society meetings. A streetcar line runs through the background.

Sourcing Cues: The photograph illustrates the growth of Black urban institutions, businesses, political organizations, and cultural life.

Document 7

Author/Origin: Original simulated statement from an interracial labor committee, Cleveland, 1935; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Labor organization statement.

“Employers have long used race to divide workers. Migrants from the South and workers born in the North must insist on equal hiring, equal pay, and union membership without color lines. A strike cannot win if one group is told another group is the enemy.”

Sourcing Cues: The statement reflects labor organizing during the New Deal era and the challenge of building interracial working-class solidarity.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 7

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible claim evaluating the extent to which the Great Migration transformed African American life and northern urban society from 1910 to 1940. The thesis must make an argument, such as that the Great Migration significantly changed Black political, economic, cultural, and community life while also creating new forms of segregation, labor conflict, and racial tension in northern cities.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader relevant context, such as Jim Crow segregation, racial violence in the South, agricultural hardship, boll weevil damage, World War I labor demand, industrialization in northern cities, racial discrimination in housing and labor, or the Great Depression.

Evidence from the Documents — 2 points: Earns 1 point for accurately using content from at least three documents to address the prompt. Earns 2 points for using content from at least six documents to support a coherent argument about migration routes, economic opportunity, southern labor control, urban employment, housing and community organizations, Black business and culture, or interracial labor organizing.

Evidence Beyond the Documents — 1 point: Earns the point for using at least one specific, relevant piece of outside evidence not found in the documents, such as the Chicago Defender, Red Summer of 1919, Harlem Renaissance, NAACP growth, National Urban League, Marcus Garvey and the UNIA, restrictive covenants, race riots in East St. Louis or Chicago, World War I industrial labor demand, or New Deal labor organizing.

Sourcing / Analysis of Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining how or why the point of view, purpose, audience, or historical situation of at least three documents is relevant to the

argument. For example, a student might analyze the migrant letter's mixed view of opportunity and discrimination, the southern editorial's concern with labor control, the reform report's purpose of pushing municipal planning, the photograph's evidence of community-building, or the labor committee's effort to overcome employer divide-and-rule strategies.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a nuanced argument, such as explaining that the Great Migration expanded freedom and opportunity while exposing migrants to new forms of segregation; comparing southern and northern racial systems; distinguishing economic, political, and cultural effects; or showing how migrants transformed cities even as cities shaped migrants' experiences.

Model Guidance:

A strong DBQ would likely argue that the Great Migration transformed African American life to a large extent by expanding wage labor opportunities, voting possibilities, community institutions, Black businesses, and cultural life in northern cities. It should also explain limits and conflicts, including housing segregation, job discrimination, racial violence, southern resistance to labor loss, and tensions within industrial workplaces. Useful document groupings include migration routes, migrant opportunity, southern white resistance, northern labor markets, community-building, urban culture, and interracial labor organizing. Relevant outside evidence could include the Chicago Defender, Red Summer, NAACP, National Urban League, Harlem Renaissance, restrictive covenants, or World War I industrial labor demand.

Expected Points:

7

APUSH-LEQ7-001

Section: LEQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 4 — Period 4: 1800–1848

Period: Cross-Period / Thematic

Theme: SOC — Social Structures

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Broad historical prompt with introductory statement

Prompt:

From the early nineteenth century through the Civil War, antislavery activism developed through the actions of enslaved people, free Black communities, white abolitionists, women reformers, religious and secular reform networks, political parties, print culture, and conflicts over fugitive slaves and western territories. These movements differed in goals and tactics, but together they helped make slavery a central issue in national life.

Evaluate the most significant causes of the growth of antislavery activism in the United States from 1800 to 1865.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 6

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible thesis that evaluates the most significant causes of the growth of antislavery activism from 1800 to 1865. The thesis must make a causal argument rather than simply describe antislavery beliefs.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader context relevant to antislavery activism, such as the expansion of slavery, the Haitian Revolution's influence, the Second Great Awakening, reform networks, free Black communities, sectional conflict, westward expansion, or the political crisis of the 1850s.

Evidence — 2 points: Earns 1 point for identifying at least two specific pieces of relevant evidence, such as Gabriel's Rebellion, Denmark Vesey's alleged conspiracy, Nat Turner's rebellion, David

Walker's Appeal, William Lloyd Garrison, the American Anti-Slavery Society, Frederick Douglass, Sojourner Truth, Harriet Tubman, the Underground Railroad, personal liberty laws, the Fugitive Slave Act of 1850, Uncle Tom's Cabin, the Liberty Party, Free Soil Party, Republican Party, John Brown, or the Emancipation Proclamation. Earns 2 points for using at least two pieces of evidence to support an argument about causes of antislavery activism.

Historical Reasoning — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining causation, such as showing how enslaved resistance, free Black activism, moral reform, abolitionist print culture, women's organizing, political conflict over slavery's expansion, or fugitive slave controversies contributed to the growth of antislavery activism.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by developing a nuanced argument, such as distinguishing between immediatist abolition, gradualism, colonization, Free Soil politics, and wartime emancipation; explaining tensions between Black and white abolitionists; showing how enslaved people's actions shaped abolitionist politics; or recognizing that antislavery activism grew through both moral reform and political conflict.

Model Guidance:

A strong LEQ should explain why antislavery activism grew, not simply list abolitionists. It might argue that activism expanded because enslaved resistance and free Black organizing challenged slavery directly, while reform movements, print culture, and conflicts over fugitive slaves and western territories drew more northerners into antislavery politics. Strong responses should also distinguish different forms of antislavery activism, from moral abolitionism to political Free Soil arguments and wartime emancipation.

Expected Points:

6

SECTION 2 — SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — DO NOT IMPORT

SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — APUSH-FRQ7

· APUSH-SAQ7-001: Unit 2; Period 2: 1607–1754; perspectives include modern secondary historians of Spanish borderlands colonization and French North American trade/diplomacy; source type is paired secondary text interpretations; source viewpoints contrast Spanish missions, presidios, conversion, and coerced/negotiated labor with French fur trade alliances, diplomacy, and smaller settler presence; historical development is comparative imperial strategy in Spanish and French North America; reasoning path is comparison using religion, trade, military outposts, Native diplomacy, and settlement patterns; misconception targeted is treating all European colonization as a single British-style settler model.

· APUSH-SAQ7-002: Unit 9; Period 9: 1980–Present; perspective is local environmental justice community organizer in North Carolina in 1982; source type is original simulated primary speech; source viewpoint emphasizes hazardous-waste siting, race, poverty, clean water, local political power, and unequal environmental risk; historical development is environmental justice activism and the connection between environmental policy and civil rights after the 1970s; reasoning path is POV/purpose/audience connected to grassroots activism and public accountability; misconception targeted is treating environmentalism as only wilderness preservation or conservation rather than community health and inequality.

· APUSH-SAQ7-003: Unit 4; Period 4: 1800–1848; perspectives include school reformers, teachers, children, state officials, families, and communities debating moral/civic education; non-text source type is described material-culture school primer; visual/data/map pattern is classroom primer with teacher, boys and girls, alphabet, morality lessons, arithmetic, republican citizenship passage, and handwritten discipline note; historical development is common school reform, literacy,

moral discipline, and civic education in the early nineteenth century; reasoning path is causation linking reform, republican citizenship, social order, and state involvement in schooling; misconception targeted is treating education reform as only literacy instruction without civic, moral, cultural, and social-control purposes.

· APUSH-DBQ7-001: Unit 7; Period 7: 1890–1945; DBQ topic is the Great Migration’s transformation of African American life and northern urban society from 1910 to 1940; document types include described migration map, Black migrant letter, southern county newspaper editorial, industrial labor data table, northern urban reform report, described Black neighborhood photograph, and interracial labor committee statement; document perspectives include Black migrants, white southern elites, northern employers and labor markets, reform organizations, Black churches/businesses/political clubs, neighborhood associations, and interracial labor organizers; main argument paths include migration from Jim Crow South to northern cities, industrial labor opportunity, southern labor-control backlash, urban housing discrimination, Black institution-building, community culture, political participation, and labor solidarity/conflict; outside evidence possibilities include Chicago Defender, Red Summer of 1919, Harlem Renaissance, NAACP, National Urban League, Marcus Garvey and UNIA, restrictive covenants, East St. Louis riot, Chicago race riot, World War I labor demand, and New Deal labor organizing; sourcing opportunities include migrant mixed perspective on opportunity and discrimination, southern elite fear of labor loss, reform report’s municipal planning purpose, photograph as evidence of Black urban community-building, and labor committee’s anti-divide-and-rule purpose; visual/data/map types include described South-to-North migration map, Black urban employment data table, and described Black business-district photograph.

· APUSH-LEQ7-001: Units 4–5; Periods 4–5 / Cross-Period; LEQ topic is causes of the growth of antislavery activism from 1800 to 1865; historical reasoning process is causation; evidence categories include enslaved resistance, Gabriel’s Rebellion, Denmark Vesey, Nat Turner, David Walker’s Appeal, William Lloyd Garrison, American Anti-Slavery Society, Frederick Douglass, Sojourner Truth, Harriet Tubman, Underground Railroad, personal liberty laws, Fugitive Slave Act of 1850, Uncle Tom’s Cabin, Liberty Party, Free Soil Party, Republican Party, John Brown, and Emancipation Proclamation; complexity path is distinguishing immediatist abolition, gradualism, colonization, Free Soil politics, Black activism, white reform networks, women’s organizing, and wartime emancipation while showing how moral and political causes interacted; misconception targeted is treating antislavery activism as only the work of white abolitionist leaders rather than a movement shaped by enslaved people, free Black communities, women, print culture, and sectional politics.